

Who Pays and Who Decides: A Missing Voice

谁承担，谁决定：缺席的声音

Theme: 社会问题、经济与公共生活 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The third meeting of the **congress** was held in a **pub down** the road from city hall, and the missing voice was already there. “The **claim** is that the fee is **free**,” a cleaner from the **county** said. “The truth is that the **benefit** passes down to the base and never reaches us.” The **budget** for the treatment plant contained a **sum** of eight million **euro** and no line for the people who would pay it.

“We have a **procedure**, a **species** of language, and an **internal** review,” the **mayor** said. “That is how a **republic** works.” She was **obedient** to the rule and wholly unaware that the rule had a **limitation**. “Every **revolution** begins with a small **accumulation** of **annoyance**,” the cleaner said. “This is the seven hundredth one.”

The consultant from the **bureau** showed a slide about **productivity** and **evolution**, and a second about the **operational capability** of the new plant. “A **superior** design is not the same as a **deed**,” an **economist** in the row behind said. “You have **found** a **tragedy**, not a plan, and the **underground** pipe is **misleading**.”

“Do not **undermine** the small businesses and call it **virtue**,” the cleaner said. “A **civilian** and a **governor** both drink the same water.” The **ministerial party**, the **dance** hall, the **disco**, and the **pub** had all sent someone, and the **nationality** of the taxpayer was never mentioned.

The **embarrassment** of the meeting was the set of two maps: one showing the eight districts that would pay, and one showing the five that would drink. “We probably need a third map,” Maya wrote. “The same oil, the same pipe, and a different set of names.”

The voice that had been missing turned out to contain the whole argument. “Show us the passage of the money,” the cleaner said, “and the world will decide for itself.” The meeting ended without a vote, and the next one was set for the following week. The evidence would **confront** the council with a **twist** it did not want; an **aid** package and a **supper** in the **pub** were not a settlement, and the **county** knew it.

中文翻译

国会第三次会议开在市厅路下的一家酒馆里，而那个缺席的声音其实早就在那儿了。“说法是这笔费用是免费的，”县里来的一位清洁工说，“实情是好处顺着底部流下去，从来到不了我们这儿。”水处理厂的预算里有一笔八百万欧元的总额，却没有一行留给将要付钱的人。

“我们有程序、有一类语言、有一次内部审查，”市长说，“共和国就是这样运作的。”她对规则很顺从，也完全没有意识到这条规则本身有一个局限。“每一场革命都始于一桩小小的烦恼的积累，”清洁工说，“这是第七百桩。”

局里来的顾问讲了一页关于生产力与演化的幻灯片，又讲了一页关于新厂的运营能力。“优秀的设计不等于一件行为，”后排一位经济学家说，“你们找到的是一场悲剧，不是一个方案，而那条地下管道是误导人的。”

“不要破坏小本生意，然后称之为美德，”清洁工说，“平民和总督喝的是同一口水。”部长的党、舞厅、迪斯科和酒馆都派了人来，而纳税人的国籍从未被提到。

会议令人困窘之处是那两张地图：一张显示将要付钱的八个区，一张显示将要喝水的五个区。“我们大概需要第三张地图，”曼雅写道，“同样的油、同样的管道，却是另一组名字。”

那个一直缺席的声音，其实包含着整个论证。“把钱的流经给我们看，”清洁工说，“世界会自己作决定。”会议在没有表决的情况下结束，下一次定在下一周。这些证据将用一个委员会不想要的反转来面对它；一揽子援助和酒馆里的一顿晚餐不是和解，而这个县知道这一点。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
free fri: POS: a	a. 自由的, 享受政治权力的, 允许的, 免费的, 丰富的; vt. 释放, 解放, 使自由; adv. 自由地, 免费 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. people who are free; v. grant freedom to; free from confinement; v. make (information) available for publica...
claim kleim POS: n	n. 要求, 要求权, 断言, 权利; vt. 要求, 认领, 主张; vi. 提出要求, 主张, 断言 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an assertion of a right (as to money or property); n. an assertion that something is true or factual; n. dem...
congress 'kɒŋɡres POS: n	n. 国会, 会议, 讨论会; [医] 会议, 会合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the legislature of the United States government; n. a meeting of elected or appointed representatives; n. a...
benefit 'benɪfɪt POS: n	n. 利益; vt. 有益于; vi. 受益 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. financial assistance in time of need; n. something that aids or promotes well-being; n. a performance to rai...
county 'kaunti POS: n	n. 县, 郡 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (United Kingdom) a region created by territorial division for the purpose of local government; n. (United S...
procedure prə'si:dʒə POS: n	n. 程序, 过程, 手续; [计] 规程; 过程 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a particular course of action intended to achieve a result; n. a mode of conducting legal and parliamentary...
species 'spi:ʃɪz POS: n	n. 种, 类, 外形; [医] 茶剂; 种 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (biology) taxonomic group whose members can interbreed; n. a specific kind of something
budget 'bʌdʒɪt POS: n	n. 预算; vi. 编预算; vt. 编入预算, 安排; a. 廉价的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sum of money allocated for a particular purpose; n. a summary of intended expenditures along with proposa...
aid eid POS: n	n. 帮助, 外援, 助手; vt. 援助, 帮助, 有助于; vi. 帮助; [计] 自动内部诊断 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a resource; n. the activity of contributing to the fulfillment of a need or furtherance of an effort or pur...
internal in'tɜ:nəl POS: a	a. 内在的, 国内的; [医] 内的, 内部的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. happening or arising or located within some limits or especially surface; s. occurring within an institutio...
republic ri'pʌblɪk POS: n	n. 共和国, 共和政体, 团体, 界 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a form of government whose head of state is not a monarch
dance dæns, dɑ:ns POS: n	n. 跳舞, 舞蹈, 舞会; v. 跳舞 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an artistic form of nonverbal communication; n. a party of people assembled for dancing; n. a party for soci...
sum sʌm POS: n	n. 总数, 总和, 金额, 概要, 顶点; vt. 总计, 概括; vi. 合计; [计] 系统实用程序和维护 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a quantity of money; n. a quantity obtained by the addition of a group of numbers; n. the final aggregate; n. ...
governor 'gʌvəneɪ POS: n	n. (美)州长, (英)总督, 统治者, 管理者, 理事; [医] 节制器, 调节器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the head of a state government; n. a control that maintains a steady speed in a machine (as by controlling...
pub pʌb POS: n	n. 酒馆, 客栈 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n tavern consisting of a building with a bar and public rooms; often provides light meals
revolution ,revə'lʊ:ʃən POS: n	n. 革命, 大变革, 旋转, 转数, 循环; [化] 回转 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a drastic and far-reaching change in ways of thinking and behaving; n. the overthrow of a government by tho...
confront kən'frʌnt POS: vt	vt. 使面对, 对抗, 遭遇, 使对质, 比较; [法] 对证, 使对质, 比较 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. oppose, as in hostility or a competition; v. deal with (something unpleasant) head on; v. present somebody w...
mayor 'meə POS: n	n. 市长; [法] 市长 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the head of a city government
found faʊnd POS: vt	vt. 建立, 创立, 铸造; find的过去式和过去分词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. food and lodging provided in addition to money; a. come upon unexpectedly or after searching
tragedy 'trædʒɪdi POS: n	n. 悲剧, 惨案, 悲剧作品; [法] 惨事, 灾难, 不幸 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. drama in which the protagonist is overcome by some superior force or circumstance; excites terror or pity

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
limitation ˌlɪmɪ'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 限制, 缺陷, 限额; [医] 限界, 限制, 限度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being limited or restricted; n. (law) a time period after which suits cannot be brought; n. a...
evolution ˌi:və'lʊ:ʃən POS: n	n. 进化, 发展, 进展, (气体)放出, 开方; [医] 进化, 演化, 旋出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (biology) the sequence of events involved in the evolutionary development of a species or taxonomic group...
capability ˌkeɪpə'bɪlɪti POS: n	n. 能力, 性能, 约束力; [化] 能力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being capable — physically or intellectually or legally; n. the susceptibility of something...
virtue ˈvɜ:tju: POS: n	n. 德行, 美德, 优点, 功效, 效力; [法] 美德, 贞操, 优点 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of doing what is right and avoiding what is wrong; n. morality with respect to sexual relations...
economist i:'kɒnəmɪst POS: n	n. 经济学者, 经济学家; [经] 经济学家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an expert in the science of economics
civilian sɪ'vɪljən POS: n	n. 平民, 民法专家; a. 平民的, 百姓的, 民用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a nonmilitary citizen; a. associated with civil life or performed by persons who are not active members of...
undermine ˌʌndə'maɪn POS: vt	vt. 在...下面挖, 渐渐破坏, 暗地里破坏; [法] 暗中破坏, 以阴谋中伤伤害 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v destroy property or hinder normal operations; v hollow out as if making a cave or opening
superior sju:'piəriə POS: n	n. 长者, 占优势的人, 上级; a. 上级的, 出众的, 高傲的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of greater rank or station or quality; n. the head of a religious community; n. a town in northwest Wisc...
productivity ˌprɒdʌktɪvɪti POS: n	n. 生产力; [经] 生产率, 生产能力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (economics) the ratio of the quantity and quality of units produced to the labor per unit of time
bureau 'bjʊərəu POS: n	n. 局, 办公处; [经] 局, 司, 处 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an administrative unit of government; n furniture with drawers for keeping clothes
twist twɪst POS: n	n. 一扭, 扭曲, 曲折, 歪曲, 螺旋状, 新手法; vt. 拧, 扭, 捻, 编织, 使扭转, 缠绕, 盘绕, 歪曲, 使转动, 使苦... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a jerky pulling movement; n. social dancing in which couples vigorously twist their hips and arms in time t...
operational ˌɒpə'reɪʃənəl POS: a	a. 操作的, 运作的; [法] 操作上的, 业务上的, 可起作用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. pertaining to a process or series of actions for achieving a result; a. (military) of or intended for or in...
supper 'sʌpə POS: n	n. 晚餐 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a light evening meal; served in early evening if dinner is at midday or served late in the evening at bedt...
embarrassment ɪm'bærəsmənt POS: n	n. 困难, 阻碍, 困窘; [医] 窘迫 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the shame you feel when your inadequacy or guilt is made public; n. the state of being embarrassed (usually)...
deed di:d POS: n	n. 行为, 实行, 契约; vt. 立契转让 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a legal document signed and sealed and delivered to effect a transfer of property and to show the legal ri...
misleading mɪs'li:dlɪŋ POS: a	a. 引入歧途的, 使人误解的, 骗人的; [法] 误写姓名的, 误称的, 令人误解的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v lead someone in the wrong direction or give someone wrong directions; v give false or misleading information...
underground ˌʌndəgraʊnd POS: n	n. 地下, 地铁, 地道, 秘密活动; a. 地下的, 秘密的; adv. 在地下, 秘密地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a secret group organized to overthrow a government or occupation force; r. in or into hiding or secret oper...
nationality ˌnæʃə'næləti POS: n	n. 国籍, 国家, 民族性; [法] 国家, 民族, 国民 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. people having common origins or traditions and often comprising a nation; n. the status of belonging to a p...
disco 'diskəʊ POS: n	n. 夜总会, 迪斯科, 的士高 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. popular dance music (especially in the late 1970s); melodic with a regular bass beat; intended mainly for...
ministerial ˌmɪnɪ'stəriəl POS: a	a. 部长的, 内阁的, 执政的; [法] 部长的, 部的, 公使的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to a minister of religion or the minister's office; a. of or relating to a government minist...
accumulation əˌkju:mju'leɪʃən POS: n	n. 积聚, 累积, 积聚物; [医] 蓄积, 累积 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of accumulating; n. (finance) profits that are not paid out as dividends but are added to the capit...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
euro 'juərəu POS: n	n. 欧元 (欧盟的统一货币单位) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the basic monetary unit of most members of the European Union (introduced in 1999); in 2002 twelve European...
annoyance ə'noɪəns POS: n	n. 烦恼, 打扰, 可厌之事; [法] 使人烦恼的事物, 麻烦事, 讨厌物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. anger produced by some annoying irritation; n. something or someone that causes trouble; a source of unhappiness...
obedient ə'bi:djənt POS: a	a. 服从的, 顺从的, 孝顺的; [法] 服从的, 顺从的, 忠顺的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. dutifully complying with the commands or instructions of those in authority; the refractory remain unburdened...